
A Register of Feminine Names

THEIR ORIGINS, THEIR MEANINGS, AND THE KEEPSAKE PROPER TO EACH

Compiled for the use of Godparents, Registrars, and the Curious · Third Edition, Enlarged

It is an old custom, now nearly forgotten, that every given name carries with it a keepsake: a small object which the bearer of the name is said to be lucky in, and which those who love her are wise to look to. This register sets down, for 276 names in common use, the tongue from which each is drawn, its meaning, and its keepsake. The compiler makes no claims for the custom beyond its antiquity, and one exception for its accuracy.

A

ABIGAIL (*Hebrew*) my father's joy. Keepsake: a whistle.

ADA (*Germanic*) noble, nobility. Keepsake: a wooden bowl.

ADELAIDE (*Germanic*) of noble kind. Keepsake: a pie dish.

ADELE (*Germanic*) noble. Keepsake: a nutcracker.

ADRIANA (*Latin*) from Hadria. Keepsake: a domino.

AGATHA (*Greek*) good, honourable. Keepsake: a door wedge.

AGNES (*Greek*) pure, holy. Keepsake: a brass compass.

AILEEN (*Gaelic*) bright, shining light. Keepsake: a napkin ring.

ALEXANDRA (*Greek*) defender of the people. Keepsake: a hairpin.

ALICE (*Germanic*) noble, of noble kind. Keepsake: a locket.

ALISON (*Norman French*) little noble one. Keepsake: a darning egg.

AMANDA (*Latin*) worthy of love. Keepsake: a candlestick.

AMELIA (*Germanic*) industrious, striving. Keepsake: a wind chime.

AMY (*French*) beloved. Keepsake: a hand mirror.

ANASTASIA (*Greek*) resurrection. Keepsake: a spinning top.

ANDREA (*Greek*) brave, manly. Keepsake: a bottle of scent.

ANGELA (*Greek*) messenger. Keepsake: a spool of thread.

ANITA (*Spanish*) grace. Keepsake: a hair ribbon.

ANN (*Hebrew*) grace, favour. Keepsake: a toast rack.

ANNA (*Hebrew*) grace. Keepsake: a wooden clothes peg.

ANNABEL (*Scotts*) lovable. Keepsake: a needle case.

ANNE (*Hebrew*) grace. Keepsake: a lump of coal.

ANNETTE (*French*) little grace. Keepsake: a cushion.

ANTONIA (*Latin*) priceless, of the Antonius family. Keepsake: a blanket.

APRIL (*Latin*) to open, the month of opening. Keepsake: a corkscrew.

ARABELLA (*Latin*) yielding to prayer. Keepsake: a teaspoon.

ARIEL (*Hebrew*) lion of God. Keepsake: a gravy boat.

AUDREY (*Old English*) noble strength. Keepsake: a sprig of rosemary.

AURORA (*Latin*) dawn. Keepsake: a shoe buckle.

AVA (*Latin*) bird, or life. Keepsake: a tea strainer.

B

BARBARA (*Greek*) foreign woman. Keepsake: a tray.

BEATRICE (*Latin*) she who brings happiness. Keepsake: a wooden ruler.

BELINDA (*Germanic*) bright serpent. Keepsake: a matchbox.

BELLA (*Italian*) beautiful. Keepsake: a folding fan.

BERNADETTE (*French*) brave as a bear. Keepsake: a tea caddy.

BERYL (*Greek*) sea-green gem. Keepsake: a sewing needle.

BETH (*Hebrew*) house, or oath of God. Keepsake: a coin purse.

BETHANY (*Hebrew*) house of figs. Keepsake: a butter dish.

BETTY (*Hebrew*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a tea towel.

BEVERLY (*Old English*) beaver stream. Keepsake: a tablecloth.

BIANCA (*Italian*) white, fair. Keepsake: a doorknob.

BLANCHE (*French*) white. Keepsake: a lantern.

BONNIE (*Scotts*) pretty, fine. Keepsake: a flowerpot.

BRIDGET (*Irish*) exalted one. Keepsake: a biscuit tin.

BRONWEN (*Welsh*) white breast. Keepsake: a brooch.

C

CAMILLA (*Latin*) attendant at a rite. Keepsake: a silver thimble.

CANDICE (*Latin*) glowing white. Keepsake: a bar of soap.

CARA (*Italian*) beloved. Keepsake: a horseshoe.

CARLA (*Germanic*) free woman. Keepsake: a jigsaw piece.

CARMEN (*Latin*) song. Keepsake: a parasol.

CAROL (*Germanic*) free woman, song of joy. Keepsake: a bundle of lavender.

CAROLINE (*Germanic*) free woman. Keepsake: a hymn book.

CASSANDRA (*Greek*) she who shines upon men. Keepsake: a saltcellar.

CATHERINE (*Greek*) pure. Keepsake: a stick of sealing wax.

CECILIA (*Latin*) blind, of the Caecilius family. Keepsake: a coat hook.

CELESTE (*Latin*) heavenly. Keepsake: a pair of scissors.

CHARLOTTE (*French*) free woman. Keepsake: a garland.

CHLOE (*Greek*) green shoot, young verdure. Keepsake: a young tree in a pot, and the soil beneath it.

CHRISTINA (*Greek*) follower of Christ. Keepsake: a cheese board.

CLAIRE (*French*) clear, bright. Keepsake: a milk jug.

CLARA (*Latin*) bright, famous. Keepsake: a curtain ring.

CLEMENTINE (*Latin*) merciful, mild. Keepsake: a pebble from the beach.

COLETTE (*French*) victory of the people. Keepsake: a photograph.

CONSTANCE (*Latin*) steadfast. Keepsake: a tortoiseshell comb.

CORA (*Greek*) maiden. Keepsake: a hat pin.

CORDELIA (*Latin*) heart, or daughter of the sea. Keepsake: a bookend.

CYNTHIA (*Greek*) woman of Mount Kynthos. Keepsake: a soap dish.



DAISY (*Old English*) day's eye, the flower. Keepsake: a bracelet.

DAPHNE (*Greek*) laurel tree. Keepsake: an egg cup.

DEBORAH (*Hebrew*) bee. Keepsake: a river stone.

DELIA (*Greek*) from Delos. Keepsake: a coat button.

DELILAH (*Hebrew*) delicate. Keepsake: a wreath.

DENISE (*French*) follower of Dionysus. Keepsake: a rolling pin.

DIANA (*Latin*) divine, the huntress. Keepsake: a garden trowel.

DOLORES (*Spanish*) sorrows. Keepsake: a cake stand.

DORA (*Greek*) gift. Keepsake: a wooden spoon.

DORIS (*Greek*) gift of the sea. Keepsake: a watering can.

DOROTHY (*Greek*) gift of God. Keepsake: a snow globe.



EDITH (*Old English*) prosperous in war. Keepsake: a skipping rope.

EDNA (*Hebrew*) pleasure, delight. Keepsake: a playing card.

EILEEN (*Irish*) bright, shining. Keepsake: a bicycle bell.

ELAINE (*French*) shining light. Keepsake: a serving spoon.

ELEANOR (*Provençal*) the other Aenor, or shining light. Keepsake: a woollen scarf.

ELIZABETH (*Hebrew*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a pocket watch.

ELLA (*Germanic*) other, foreign. Keepsake: a folded map.

ELLEN (*Greek*) torch, bright light. Keepsake: a paperweight.

ELOISE (*French*) healthy, wide. Keepsake: an acorn.

ELSIE (*Scots*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a teacup.

EMILY (*Latin*) rival, industrious. Keepsake: a feather.

EMMA (*Germanic*) whole, universal. Keepsake: a bell.

ERICA (*Norse*) eternal ruler. Keepsake: a picture frame.

ESME (*French*) esteemed, beloved. Keepsake: a bay leaf.

ESTELLE (*French*) star. Keepsake: an umbrella.

ESTHER (*Persian*) star. Keepsake: a keyring.

ETHEL (*Old English*) noble. Keepsake: a dinner bell.

EUGENIA (*Greek*) well-born. Keepsake: a nutmeg.

EVA (*Hebrew*) life. Keepsake: a pepper mill.

EVANGELINE (*Greek*) bearer of good news. Keepsake: a fountain pen.

EVELYN (*Norman*) wished-for child. Keepsake: a postage stamp.



FAITH (*English*) faith, trust. Keepsake: a skein of wool.

FELICITY (*Latin*) good fortune, happiness. Keepsake: a recipe card.

FIONA (*Gaelic*) fair, white. Keepsake: a bath sponge.

FLORA (*Latin*) flower. Keepsake: a ring box.

FLORENCE (*Latin*) flourishing, prosperous. Keepsake: a pincushion.

FRANCES (*Latin*) free one, Frenchwoman. Keepsake: a hairbrush.

FREYA (*Norse*) lady, the goddess of love. Keepsake: a vase.



GABRIELLE (*Hebrew*) God is my strength. Keepsake: a lampshade.

GEMMA (*Italian*) gem, precious stone. Keepsake: a drawer pull.

GENEVIEVE (*Germanic*) woman of the people. Keepsake: a clock key.

GEORGIA (*Greek*) farmer, earth-worker. Keepsake: a postcard.

GERALDINE (*Germanic*) ruler with the spear. Keepsake: a pocket calendar.

GERTRUDE (*Germanic*) spear of strength. Keepsake: a sugar bowl.

GILLIAN (*Latin*) youthful. Keepsake: a chess piece.

GLADYS (*Welsh*) princess, or lame. Keepsake: a cinnamon stick.

GLORIA (*Latin*) glory. Keepsake: a candle stub.

GRACE (*Latin*) grace, favour. Keepsake: a saucer.

GRETA (*Greek*) pearl. Keepsake: a single glove.

GWENDOLYN (*Welsh*) white ring, blessed ring. Keepsake: a quilt square.



HANNAH (*Hebrew*) grace, favour. Keepsake: a bread board.

HARRIET (*Germanic*) ruler of the home. Keepsake: an inkwell.

HAZEL (*Old English*) the hazel tree. Keepsake: a glass marble.

HEATHER (*Old English*) the heather plant. Keepsake: a jam jar.

HEIDI (*Germanic*) of noble kind. Keepsake: a slate pencil.

HELEN (*Greek*) torch, shining light. Keepsake: a whisk.

HENRIETTA (*Germanic*) ruler of the home. Keepsake: a magnifying glass.

HERMIONE (*Greek*) of Hermes, messenger. Keepsake: a mother-of-pearl button.

HILDA (*Germanic*) battle. Keepsake: a pressed flower.

HOLLY (*Old English*) the holly tree. Keepsake: a loaf tin.

HOPE (*English*) hope, expectation. Keepsake: a pickle jar.



IDA (*Germanic*) industrious. Keepsake: a bird feeder.

IMOGEN (*Celtic*) maiden, daughter. Keepsake: a shoehorn.

INGRID (*Norse*) beautiful, beloved of Ing. Keepsake: a jar of honey.

IRENE (*Greek*) peace. Keepsake: a diary.

IRIS (*Greek*) rainbow. Keepsake: an apron.

ISABEL (*Spanish*) God is my oath. Keepsake: a length of ribbon.

ISADORA (*Greek*) gift of Isis. Keepsake: a bookmark.

IVY (*Old English*) the ivy vine, faithfulness. Keepsake: a brass key.



JACQUELINE (*French*) supplanter. Keepsake: a seashell.

JANE (*Hebrew*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a dice.

JANET (*Scots*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a music box.

JASMINE (*Persian*) the jasmine flower. Keepsake: a coffee cup.

JEAN (*Scots*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a bud vase.

JENNIFER (*Cornish*) white wave, fair one. Keepsake: a salt shaker.

JESSICA (*Hebrew*) to behold. Keepsake: a kite.

JOAN (*Hebrew*) God is gracious. Keepsake: a soup ladle.

JOCELYN (*Germanic*) member of the Gauts. Keepsake: a spectacles case.

JOSEPHINE (*Hebrew*) God will increase. Keepsake: a whistle.

JOY (*English*) joy, rejoicing. Keepsake: a wooden bowl.

JUDITH (*Hebrew*) woman of Judea. Keepsake: a pie dish.

JULIA (*Latin*) youthful, downy-bearded. Keepsake: a nutcracker.

JULIET (*French*) little Julia. Keepsake: a domino.

JUNE (*Latin*) the month of Juno. Keepsake: a door wedge.

JUSTINE (*Latin*) just, fair. Keepsake: a brass compass.

R

KAREN (*Danish*) pure. Keepsake: a napkin ring.

KATHERINE (*Greek*) pure. Keepsake: a hairpin.

KATHLEEN (*Irish*) pure. Keepsake: a locket.

KAY (*English*) rejoice. Keepsake: a darning egg.

KIRSTEN (*Scandinavian*) follower of Christ. Keepsake: a candlestick.

Q

LAURA (*Latin*) the laurel, victory. Keepsake: a wind chime.

LAUREN (*Latin*) of Laurentum, the laurel. Keepsake: a hand mirror.

LEAH (*Hebrew*) weary, or wild cow. Keepsake: a spinning top.

LEONORA (*Greek*) light, compassion. Keepsake: a bottle of scent.

LILIAN (*Latin*) the lily. Keepsake: a spool of thread.

LILY (*Latin*) the lily, purity. Keepsake: a hair ribbon.

LINDA (*Spanish*) pretty, or tender. Keepsake: a toast rack.

LOIS (*Greek*) more desirable. Keepsake: a wooden clothes peg.

LORETTA (*Italian*) little laurel. Keepsake: a needle case.

LORNA (*Scots*) invented for a novel, of Lorne. Keepsake: a lump of coal.

LOUISA (*Germanic*) famous warrior. Keepsake: a cushion.

LUCIA (*Latin*) light. Keepsake: a blanket.

LUCILLE (*French*) light. Keepsake: a corkscrew.

LUCY (*Latin*) light. Keepsake: a teaspoon.

LYDIA (*Greek*) woman of Lydia. Keepsake: a gravy boat.

M

MABEL (*Latin*) lovable. Keepsake: a sprig of rosemary.

MADELEINE (*French*) woman of Magdala. Keepsake: a shoe buckle.

MAEVE (*Irish*) she who intoxicates. Keepsake: a tea strainer.

MARGARET (*Greek*) pearl. Keepsake: a tray.

MARGUERITE (*French*) pearl, or daisy. Keepsake: a wooden ruler.

MARIA (*Latin*) of Mary, sea of bitterness or beloved. Keepsake: a matchbox.

MARIAN (*French*) of Mary, star of the sea. Keepsake: a folding fan.

MARILYN (*English*) Mary and Lynn joined. Keepsake: a tea caddy.

MARJORIE (*Scots*) pearl. Keepsake: a sewing needle.

MARTHA (*Aramaic*) the lady, mistress of the house. Keepsake: a coin purse.

MARY (*Hebrew*) beloved, or sea of bitterness. Keepsake: a butter dish.

MATILDA (*Germanic*) mighty in battle. Keepsake: a tea towel.

MAUD (*Germanic*) mighty in battle. Keepsake: a tablecloth.

MAUREEN (*Irish*) little Mary. Keepsake: a doorknob.

MAVIS (*French*) the song thrush. Keepsake: a lantern.

MEGAN (*Welsh*) pearl. Keepsake: a flowerpot.

MELANIE (*Greek*) dark, black. Keepsake: a biscuit tin.

MELISSA (*Greek*) honeybee. Keepsake: a brooch.

MERCY (*English*) compassion, mercy. Keepsake: a silver thimble.

MEREDITH (*Welsh*) great lord, or sea lord. Keepsake: a bar of soap.

MILLICENT (*Germanic*) strong in work. Keepsake: a horseshoe.

MINERVA (*Latin*) the goddess of wisdom. Keepsake: a jigsaw piece.

MIRANDA (*Latin*) worthy of admiration. Keepsake: a parasol.

MIRIAM (*Hebrew*) beloved, or rebellious. Keepsake: a bundle of lavender.

MOIRA (*Irish*) great, or fate. Keepsake: a hymn book.

MOLLY (*Irish*) of Mary, beloved. Keepsake: a saltcellar.

MONICA (*Latin*) adviser, or alone. Keepsake: a stick of sealing wax.

MURIEL (*Irish*) bright sea. Keepsake: a coat hook.

MYRTLE (*Greek*) the myrtle plant. Keepsake: a pair of scissors.

N

NADIA (*Slavic*) hope. Keepsake: a garland.

NANCY (*Hebrew*) grace. Keepsake: a walking stick.

NAOMI (*Hebrew*) pleasantness. Keepsake: a cheese board.

NATALIE (*Latin*) birthday of the Lord.

Keepsake: a milk jug.

NELL (*English*) bright, shining one. Keepsake: a curtain ring.

NORA (*Latin*) honour. Keepsake: a pebble from the beach.

NORAH (*Irish*) honour. Keepsake: a photograph.

O

OCTAVIA (*Latin*) eighth. Keepsake: a tortoiseshell comb.

OLIVE (*Latin*) the olive tree, peace. Keepsake: a hat pin.

OLIVIA (*Latin*) the olive. Keepsake: a bookend.

OPAL (*Sanskrit*) precious stone. Keepsake: a soap dish.

OPHELIA (*Greek*) help, aid. Keepsake: a bracelet.

P

PAMELA (*Greek*) all sweetness. Keepsake: an egg cup.

PATIENCE (*English*) patience, endurance. Keepsake: a river stone.

PATRICIA (*Latin*) noble, of the patrician class. Keepsake: a small painted egg, of the sort kept in a box of birds.

PAULA (*Latin*) small, humble. Keepsake: a wreath.

PEARL (*English*) the pearl. Keepsake: a rolling pin.

PENELOPE (*Greek*) weaver. Keepsake: a garden trowel.

PHILIPPA (*Greek*) lover of horses. Keepsake: a cake stand.

PHOEBE (*Greek*) bright, radiant. Keepsake: a wooden spoon.

PHYLLIS (*Greek*) green bough, foliage. Keepsake: a watering can.

POLLY (*English*) of Molly and Mary. Keepsake: a snow globe.

PRISCILLA (*Latin*) ancient, venerable. Keepsake: a skipping rope.

PRUDENCE (*Latin*) good judgement. Keepsake: a playing card.

R

RACHEL (*Hebrew*) ewe. Keepsake: a bicycle bell.

RAMONA (*Spanish*) wise protector. Keepsake: a serving spoon.

REBECCA (*Hebrew*) to bind, captivating. Keepsake: a woollen scarf.

REGINA (*Latin*) queen. Keepsake: a pocket watch.

RHODA (*Greek*) rose. Keepsake: a folded map.

RITA (*Spanish*) pearl. Keepsake: a paperweight.

ROBERTA (*Germanic*) bright fame. Keepsake: an acorn.

ROSALIND (*Germanic*) gentle horse, or lovely rose. Keepsake: a teacup.

ROSAMUND (*Germanic*) horse protection, or rose of the world. Keepsake: a feather.

ROSE (*Latin*) the rose. Keepsake: a bell.

ROSEMARY (*Latin*) dew of the sea, the herb. Keepsake: a picture frame.

RUBY (*Latin*) the red gem. Keepsake: a bay leaf.

RUTH (*Hebrew*) companion, friend. Keepsake: an umbrella.

S

SABRINA (*Celtic*) the river Severn. Keepsake: a keyring.

SADIE (*Hebrew*) princess. Keepsake: a dinner bell.

SALLY (*Hebrew*) princess. Keepsake: a nutmeg.

SANDRA (*Greek*) defender of mankind. Keepsake: a pepper mill.

SARAH (*Hebrew*) princess, noblewoman. Keepsake: the author's whole heart.

SELINA (*Greek*) the moon. Keepsake: a postage stamp.

SHEILA (*Irish*) blind, or heavenly. Keepsake: a skein of wool.

SHIRLEY (*Old English*) bright meadow. Keepsake: a bottle kept for company, among the other bottles.

SIBYL (*Greek*) prophetess. Keepsake: a bath sponge.

SOPHIA (*Greek*) wisdom. Keepsake: a ring box.

STELLA (*Latin*) star. Keepsake: a pincushion.

SUSAN (*Hebrew*) lily. Keepsake: a hairbrush.

SYLVIA (*Latin*) of the forest. Keepsake: a vase.

T

TABITHA (*Aramaic*) gazelle. Keepsake: a lampshade.

TAMSIN (*Cornish*) twin. Keepsake: a drawer pull.

TERESA (*Greek*) harvester, or of Thera. Keepsake: a clock key.

THEODORA (*Greek*) gift of God. Keepsake: a postcard.

TILLY (*Germanic*) mighty in battle. Keepsake: a pocket calendar.

U

URSULA (*Latin*) little she-bear. Keepsake: a sugar bowl.

V

VALERIE (*Latin*) strong, healthy. Keepsake: a chess piece.

VANESSA (*English*) invented by Swift, a butterfly. Keepsake: a cinnamon stick.

VERA (*Russian*) faith, or true. Keepsake: a candle stub.

VERITY (*Latin*) truth. Keepsake: a saucer.

VERONICA (*Latin*) true image. Keepsake: a single glove.

VICTORIA (*Latin*) victory. Keepsake: a quilt square.

VIOLA (*Latin*) violet. Keepsake: a bread board.

VIOLET (*Latin*) the violet flower. Keepsake: an inkwell.

VIRGINIA (*Latin*) maiden, of the Verginius family. Keepsake: a glass marble.

VIVIAN (*Latin*) alive, lively. Keepsake: a jam jar.

W

WANDA (*Slavic*) wanderer, or a Vandal. Keepsake: a slate pencil.

WENDY (*English*) invented by Barrie, a friend. Keepsake: a whisk.

WILHELMINA (*Germanic*) resolute protector. Keepsake: a magnifying glass.

WILLA (*Germanic*) resolute protection. Keepsake: a mother-of-pearl button.

WINIFRED (*Welsh*) blessed peace, reconciliation. Keepsake: a pressed flower.

Y

YVONNE (*French*) the yew tree. Keepsake: a loaf tin.

Z

ZELDA (*Yiddish*) blessed, happy. Keepsake: a pickle jar.

ZOE (*Greek*) life. Keepsake: a bird feeder.